Desk review, Thu Oct 15

Oct 15, 2026 · @Louis

Today looks like a washout, not yet a bottom: falling yields lifted the Dow and S&P 500 after an Asian chip crash. TSMC beat but TSM US trades 2–4% lower, so we run **branch M**: US orders by 3:30 PM, 2330 TT tonight, and today's low must hold Friday.

The tape

Market	Move (US: open, then midday)	Why
Asia	Kospi −7.6%, Nikkei −4.9%, Taiex −3.4%	SK hynix −11%, Samsung −9%
S&P 500	−0.5%, then up to +0.3%; Dow up to +1%	Consumer, health care
Nasdaq	−1.3%, then −0.2% to −1.4%	SOX −4.2% on Wednesday
10-year yield	5.30% after PPI, then 5.05%	Bonds turned stocks

PPI: 6.3% y/y against 5.5% expected; Oct 28 hike odds 34–54%. Brent about $104, −2%.

TSMC and the branch

Revenue ($46.7B) and EPS ($4.60 per ADR) beat, and Q4 guidance implies +14% from Q3, but gross margin slipped to 66.4%. TSM US closed Wednesday at $430.00, then traded −3.8% at 10:26 AM and −2.4% at 11:49 AM. The 11:00 bar decides (−3% or worse is B); we take M either way, as the stock is back in the M band.

Our names

	VLO	XOM	RTX	LMT	GOOGL	NVDA
Plan price	$436.00	$172.15	$186.66	$512.80	$352.72	$226.32
Latest seen	$459.78	$177.01		$522.23	$347.64	$221.30
Stop	$401.12	$161.82	$175.46	$482.03	$331.56	$208.21

Mostly Oct 14 closes; no RTX quote. GOOGL is closest to its stop, 4.8% above. RTX, VLO and LMT report Oct 20–22.

Today and Friday

- [ ] **By 3:30 PM:** NVDA $100k and GOOGL to $198k (both Friday if the Nasdaq-100 was down over 1.5% at 10:30); energy and defense to $150k each.
- [ ] **9:30 PM:** 2330 TT, $100k.
- [ ] **Friday:** a break of today's lows or a 10-year above 5.30% stops new AI buys; sweep cash into energy and defense. $990k+ invested by 3:30 PM.

Sources (noon ET search results; verify on the terminal): Yahoo · TheStreet · Yahoo live · Sharecast · Nasdaq (SOX) · TSMC 6-K · Investing.com · MSN (TSM) · Globe and Mail (PPI) · CNBC (PPI) · Trading Economics (Brent) · NVDA · GOOGL · VLO · XOM · LMT · VLO date · LMT date